

Nuclear detonation

ACTION CHECKLIST

After a nuclear detonation, get inside the nearest sturdy building as quickly as you can. Move to a basement or central interior area, away from walls, windows, and the roof. Stay inside and tune to official updates; the first 24 hours are especially important unless the building is unsafe or authorities direct you elsewhere.

[] Get inside

Do not remain outdoors looking at the blast or travel across town for a preferred shelter. A substantial building offers better protection than a vehicle or open space.

[] Go deeper inside

Use a basement or the middle of the building with as much material between you and outdoors as possible. Close doors and windows.

[] If exposed outdoors, clean up

Once sheltered, remove the outer layer of clothing and set it aside away from people; wash exposed skin with water and soap when available. This reduces contamination brought indoors.

[] Stay tuned

Use radio, phone, or other available channels for location-specific instructions. Avoid going out to collect family members who are already sheltered elsewhere.

WATCH FOR

Fallout conditions vary by place and time. Do not treat a fixed distance or a clock as an all-clear; use the official instructions for your location. Potassium iodide is not a general radiation antidote and should be taken only when public-health officials advise it.

Updated 2026-10-02 | General guidance. Follow current local instructions. In immediate danger, contact emergency services.

Full guide: <https://ospreyzero.com/emergencies/nuclear-detonation/>

CDC · Radiation emergencies

CDC · Get inside

CDC · Stay inside

EPA · Radiation emergency preparedness